

◆ Step 1: Create a Big Size Text File

You can use base64 or head to generate random data:

```
base64 /dev/urandom | head -c 1000 > bigfile.txt
```

This creates a file of ~**1KB**, which is enough to avoid the zip2john "Skipping short file" error.

◆ Step 2: Create a Password-Protected ZIP

```
zip --password mypass123 secret.zip bigfile.txt
```

This will:

- Compress bigfile.txt into secret.zip
- Set the password to mypass123

◆ Step 3: Extract ZIP Hash Using zip2john

```
zip2john secret.zip > ziphash.txt
```

You should now see a hash stored in ziphash.txt.

◆ Step 4: Crack Password Using Wordlist

```
john ziphash.txt --wordlist=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt
```

John will begin testing passwords from the wordlist.

◆ Step 5: Display the Cracked Password

```
john --show ziphash.txt
```

Example output:

```
secret.zip:mypass123
```